

Google's 'Plus Codes' makes navigation in India easy

Google has created 'Plus Codes' for addresses that are not so easily located using conventional descriptors like street names or house numbers. In fact, according to a World Bank estimate, half of the world's urban population lives on unnamed streets.

For individuals and families, 'Plus Codes' can be used like a street address when the street has no name or doesn't even exist.

It is known that locating an address is quite challenging in a country like India. Often addresses are unique in format, and vary across regions, localities and use cases. The other reality is that millions of people and places in India are hard to locate — especially those in remote areas.

'Plus Codes' gives anyone in the world an address they can share, for free. By open sourcing this technology, anyone can see how it works and develop their



own applications for any purpose. Thus there is no need for licence fees or other payments.

The system of 'Plus Codes' works by dividing the geographical surface of the Earth into tiny 'tiled areas', attributing a unique code to each of them. It works offline and on print when overlaid as a grid on existing maps. Places that are close together share similar plus codes, while the system is identifiable by the '+' symbol in every address.

'Plus Codes' is an open source solution composed of 10 characters that works globally. It comprises a 'six-character + city' format. It can be generated, shared and searched by anyone using Google Maps on their smartphone.

Ravi Pinto, director – product management, Oracle Cloud Platform, said, "In the cloud economy, businesses are always searching for innovative ways to increase their developer velocity and agility, to accelerate digital transformation. Developers increasingly prefer open, cloud-neutral and community-driven container-native software stacks that enable them to avoid cloud lock-in and to



run in a true hybrid mode – so they can use the same stack in the cloud – for that matter on any cloud – as they run on-premises."

During the event, Oracle identified a few key trends in the Indian developer ecosystem.

One of them is the conversational UI, which means embedding AI into apps with chatbots. Not only are chatbots a tool that business partners will value but are the building blocks for machine learning systems that use natural language conversations, image analytics, augmented reality and enterprise data.

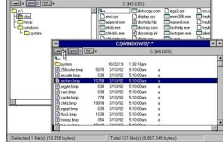
Serverless computing was another trend noted, which provides fantastic benefits to developers as they focus on the functionality of their code. Additionally, it is elastic, executes complex transactions and provides maximum portability. Next, Java remains the top choice for companies capable of handling traditional and new styles of programming. This implies that as enterprises inevitably migrate more workloads to the cloud, Java is a great foundation for serverless skills.

Blockchain, another new trend, has opened up several new growth avenues, especially in industries that were more prone to fraud. Developers are creating innovative solutions in finance, logistics, and other verticals by leveraging permissioned blockchain technology.

Oracle Code is a global initiative that empowers developers to build modern applications with an open, modern and easy-to-use development cloud platform. It enables developers to get a deep, hands-on view into emerging technologies and techniques for modern cloud development.

Microsoft Windows 95 file manager gets open sourced

Microsoft has released the source code for its original Windows file manager. While it's a relic from the past, one can now compile it from the source code.



The code requires a few small modifications to run on Windows 10 in 32-bit mode, but there are already forks which compile it in 64-bit mode, without issues.

It's as nostalgic as running Windows 95 on an Xbox One, Apple Watch or Android smartwatch. If you're a fan of the original Windows

file manager, you can download the app from GitHub and remind yourself of what computing used to look like years ago.

The source code is available on GitHub. Before open sourcing it, Microsoft veteran Craig Wittenberg had been maintaining it under the MIT licence. He had copied the file manager code from Windows NT 4 back in 2007.